

IOANNIS KALAITZIDIS

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SUMMARY

MSc student in Cybersecurity and Artificial Intelligence with an academic background in Informatics and Telecommunications. Gained practical exposure to web development and software programming through academic projects, complemented by professional experience in 1st/2nd-level IT systems support within the public sector. Focused on applying theoretical knowledge to practice, demonstrated through multiple hands-on cybersecurity lab projects. Highly motivated to leverage problem-solving skills and technical foundations to protect digital infrastructures in a cybersecurity role.

EDUCATION

MSc, Cybersecurity and Artificial Intelligence Technologies

Expected Graduation March 2027

University of Piraeus

- Erasmus+ Mobility: Selected to conduct Master's Thesis research at Sapienza University of Rome (Upcoming: Winter Semester 2026-2027)

BSc, Informatics and Telecommunications

Graduated July 2025

University of Thessaly

Ranked 1st in Graduating Class

Thesis: "Web-based educational application with a game-based quiz for evaluating and learning Python programming in secondary education" (Grade: 10/10)

Certification: Pedagogical Competence

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: English (C2), Greek (Native)

Programming: Python, C, C++, Java, C#, Bash, HTML, CSS, JavaScript

Cybersecurity and Network Tools: Metasploit, Burp Suite, Wireshark, Nmap, Palo Alto, GDB, Scapy, Ettercap, ModSecurity

Frameworks, Databases and Dev Tools: Unity, OpenCV, Firebase, Bootstrap, VVenC Encoder

Operating Systems: Windows, MacOS, Linux

Certifications: Introduction to Cloud (Grow with Google - May 2024), Network Basics (CISCO - In Progress), CompTIA Security+ (In Progress)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

T Support Trainer and Support - Netcompany, Orestiada-Didymoteicho, Greece

Jan 2026 – May 2026

- Provided on-the-job guidance and comprehensive 1st and 2nd-level IT support to judicial employees in civil court departments and the prosecution office, ensuring a smooth transition to a newly developed digital application.
- Mastered the application's functionality and civil court workflows using official technical manuals, resolving routine user inquiries and actively troubleshooting more complex technical issues.
- Assisted court staff in their day-to-day operations to facilitate smooth software adoption and improve digital efficiency within the public sector.

Military Service: Reserve Second Lieutenant / Research and IT Corps - Hellenic Army, Orestiada, Greece

Nov 2024 – Jan 2026

- Managed information systems reliability and provided comprehensive IT support within the Information Research Office.
- Conducted system monitoring, basic server maintenance and user support to ensure smooth IT infrastructure operations.
- Prepared technical documentation and collaborated with cross-functional teams to troubleshoot technical challenges under strict procedural timelines.

ACADEMIC PROJECTS

Cybersecurity Lab Projects and Case Studies (MSc)

Oct 2025 – Jan 2026

- Penetration Testing and Vulnerability Exploitation:** Conducted full-cycle penetration tests based on the Cyber Kill Chain, exploiting Windows Server vulnerabilities, Heartbleed (CVE-2014-0160), and buffer overflows using Metasploit, Nmap, and GDB. Performed Red Teaming on web applications targeting SQLi and XSS vulnerabilities via Burp Suite.
- Network Security and MitM Attacks:** Executed Man-in-the-Middle attacks (ARP/DNS Spoofing, TCP Session Hijacking) and low-level packet sniffing in Kali Linux environments utilizing Wireshark, Ettercap, and

Python (Scapy).

- **Defense-in-Depth and Infrastructure:** Configured Palo Alto Firewalls with strict access policies and set up DNS servers (BIND9) in virtualized environments. Implemented robust server defenses combining iptables and ModSecurity WAF to block unauthorized access and web attacks.
- **Malware Analysis and Risk Management:** Analyzed evasive malware attack chains (shellcode injection, PID spoofing) utilizing Sysmon and System Informer. Evaluated major risk management frameworks (ISO/IEC 27005:2022, NIST) and practical GRC tools (SimpleRisk, Monarc, Verinice, EAR/PILAR).
- **Lightweight Cryptography and IoT Security:** Analyzed the **NIST SP 800-232** standard and the **Ascon** algorithm family, the official lightweight cryptography solution for resource-constrained IoT devices. Evaluated "sponge" architecture, AEAD, and Hashing functions, focusing on the trade-offs between 128-bit security and hardware efficiency.

Software Engineering and Web Development Projects (BSc)

Oct 2020 – July 2025

- **Web-Based Educational Platform (Thesis):** Developed a full-stack application with an integrated interactive Unity/C# game to evaluate students' Python skills. Built the front-end using HTML/CSS/JS and Bootstrap, utilizing Firebase for cloud-based user data storage.
- **Game Development:** Created a 2D arcade-style game ("Oh-Mummy" clone) in Python and developed multiple 2D interactive games in Unity utilizing C# scripting.
- **System Programming and Media Processing:** Implemented digital image processing applications in C++ (OpenCV), applied video compression techniques using VVenC and developed Linux system programs utilizing C (pipes, sockets) and Bash scripting.

OTHER WORK EXPERIENCE

Retail Shop Trainee - COSMOTE, Orestiada, Greece

Jul 2023 – Aug 2023

- Supported daily sales operations and provided high-quality customer service.
- Developed a strong foundational knowledge of modern telecommunications products and technical devices.

ACTIVITIES

Volunteer Blood and Bone Marrow Donor

- Registered bone marrow donor (since August 2021) and regular blood donor (since October 2021), demonstrating a continuous and active commitment to public health and social responsibility.